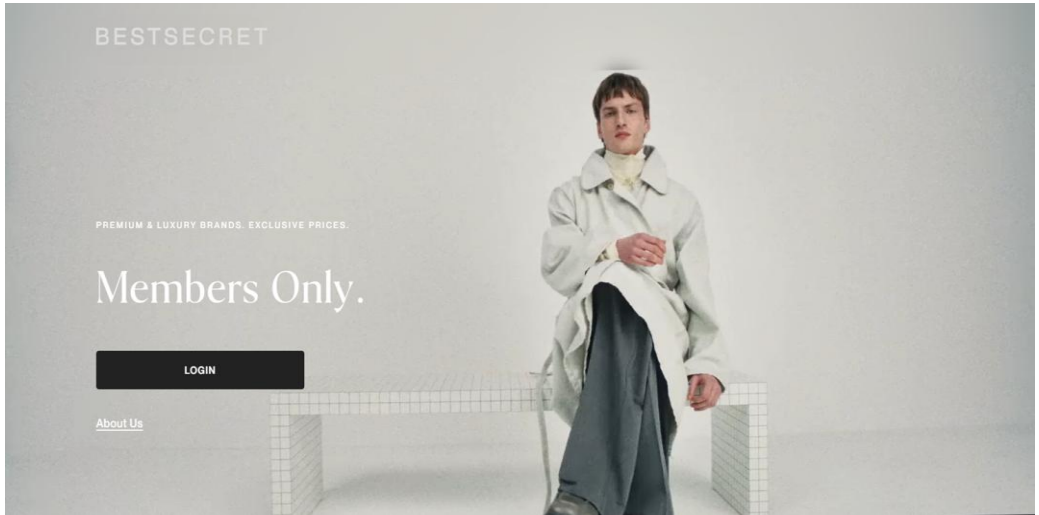
A UI/UX Analysis of BestSecret

www.bestsecret.com

By Shanice C. Sagonda, VUŠA, 2026

INTRODUCTION

- BestSecret is an e-commerce platform that offers fashion and lifestyle products at discounted prices
- Access to this site is limited to members only.Account creation cannot be done without receiving an invite from an existing user.
- BestSecret is available as a mobile app and as an **online website.**
- This analysis utilizes **Jakob Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics to evaluate and rate the online website(www.bestsecret.com)**
- **For each Usability Heuristic, pros are in green and cons and recommendations in red.**

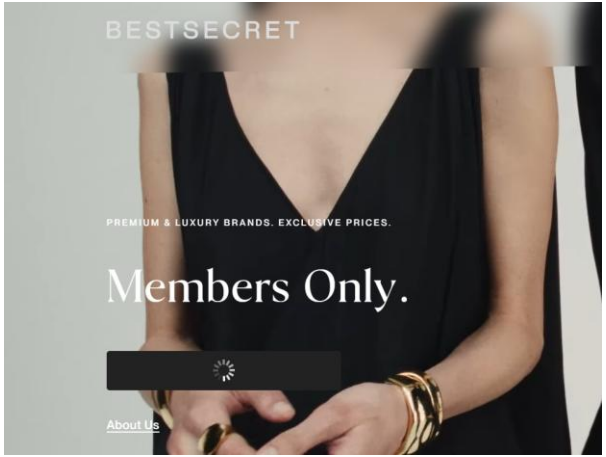


1. Visibility of system status -0.8

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

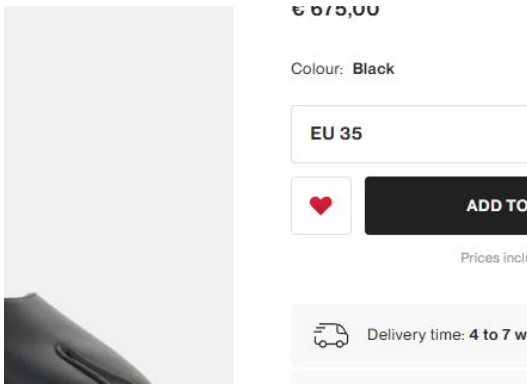
Cart Dynamics: cart quantity subscript is immediately updated upon addition of items(1.3)
Visual Indicators: Side panels for cart additions, throbbers for login processing and heart icons turning red keep the user informed.(1.1,1.2,1.4)

Loading State: When filters are applied, the page goes entirely white. There is no loading message or "fetching" state to inform the user the system is working.
Recommendation: Using a skeleton screen or a progress bar when refreshing product grids is preferred as it would make user informed of the page's loading.

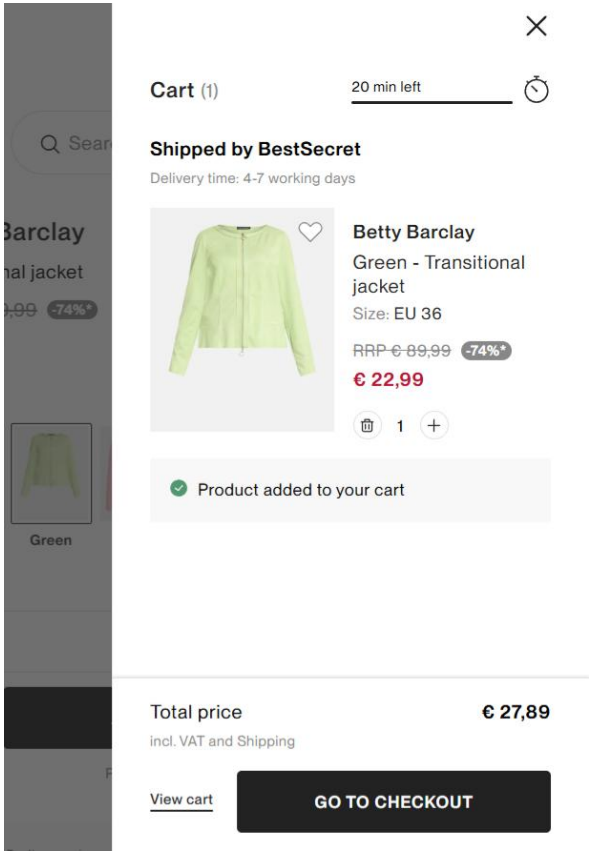


1.1

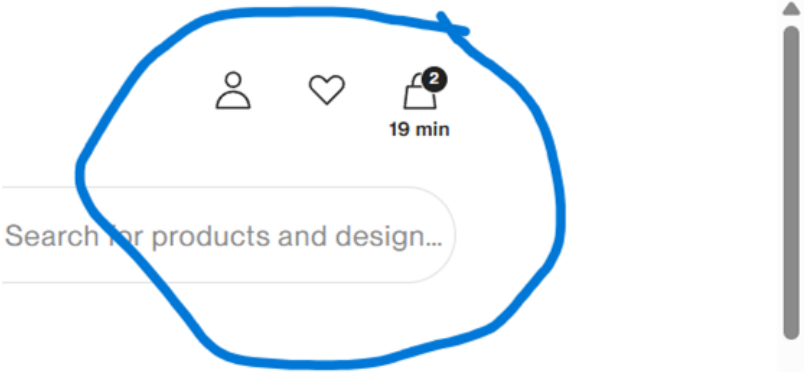
1.4



1.2


Cart (1)
20 min left
Shipped by BestSecret
Delivery time: 4-7 working days
Betty Barclay
Green - Transitional jacket
Size: EU 36
RRP € 89,99 -74%*
€ 22,99
1
Product added to your cart
Total price
€ 27,89
incl. VAT and Shipping
View cart
GO TO CHECKOUT

1.3

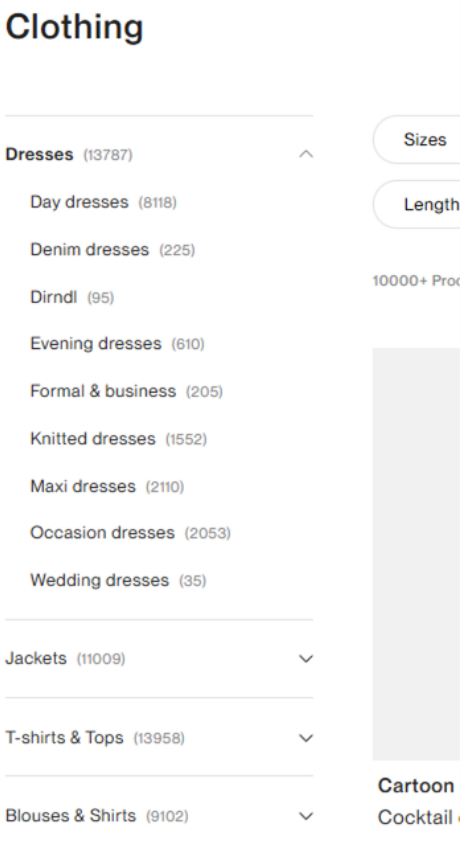

2
19 min
Search for products and design...

2. Match between system and the real world-0.9

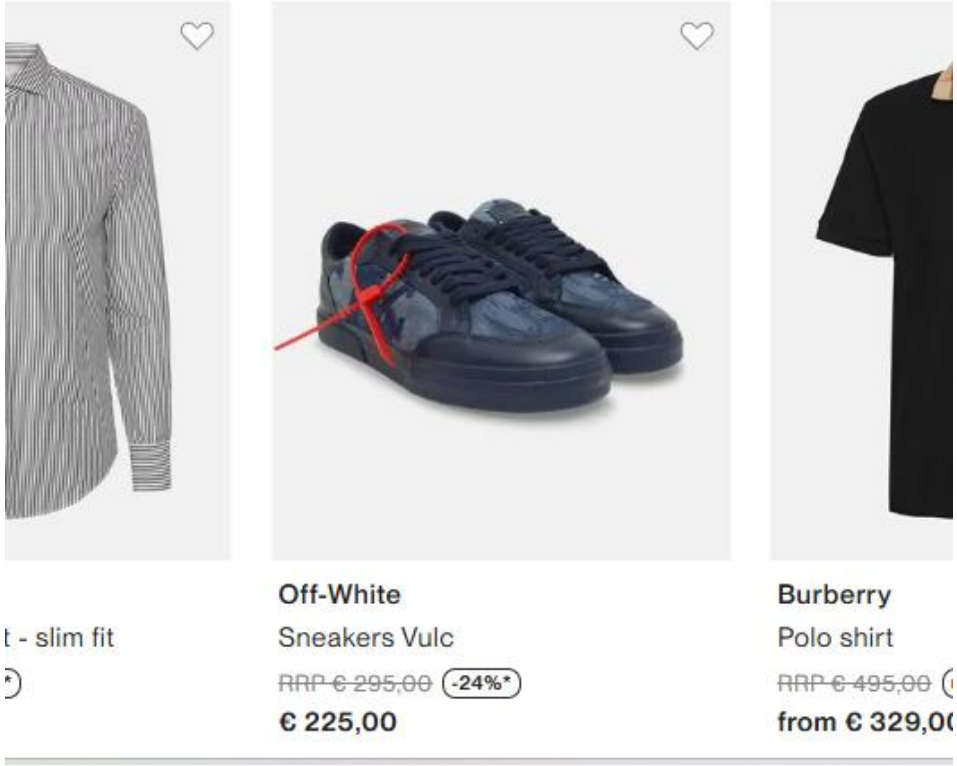
The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon.

2.1

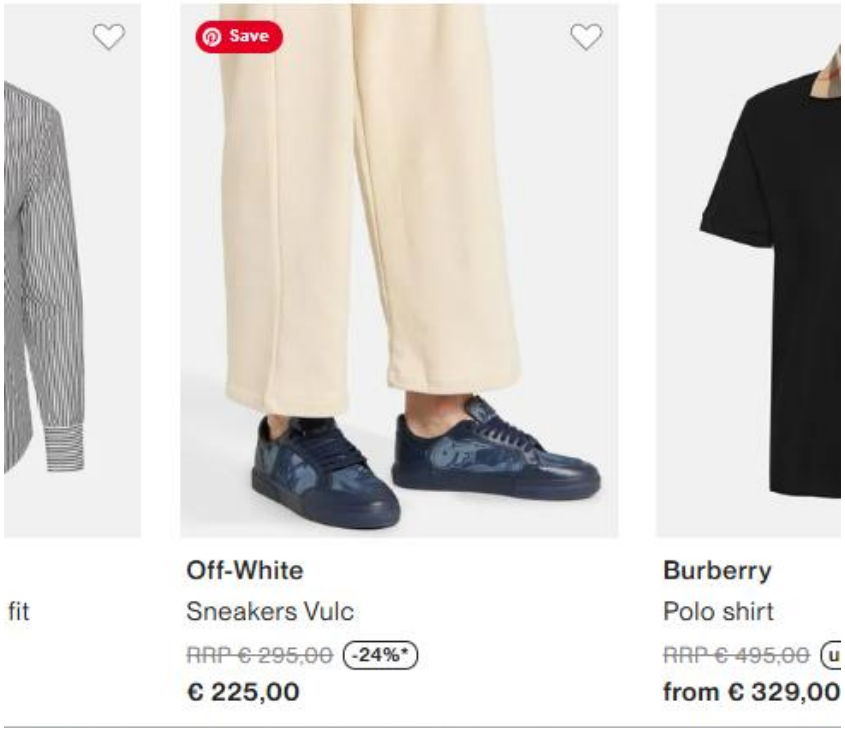
- Contextual Imagery: Hovering over product images shows alternate views (item vs. item-on-model) mimicking the real-world experience of seeing a garment's fit. Using a shopping bag icon for the cart showing that items added to it will be purchased, similar to real world retail.(2.1,2.2,2.3)
- Language Balance: Uses standard category names ("Dresses") for accessibility but includes fashion-specific terms ("Dirndl") for specialized shopping.
- Recommendation: Ensure hover-zoom or alternate views are consistent across all categories (including the



2.4


t - slim fit
Off-White
Sneakers Vulc
RRP € 295,00
-24%*
€ 225,00
Burberry
Polo shirt
RRP € 495,00
from € 329,0

2.2

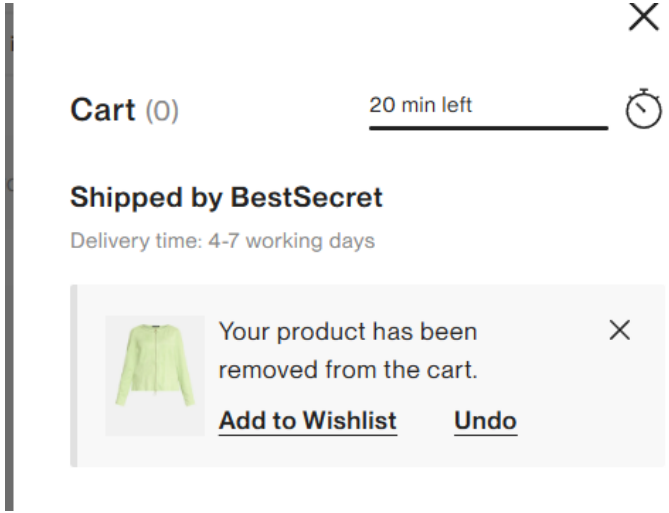

Save
fit
Off-White
Sneakers Vulc
RRP € 295,00
-24%*
€ 225,00
Burberry
Polo shirt
RRP € 495,00
from € 329,00

2.3

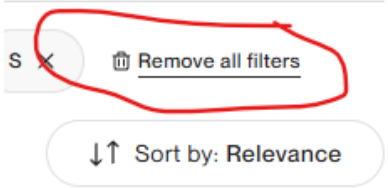
3. User control and freedom-0.7

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Efficiency Shortcut: A "Remove All Filters" button allows users to clear their filters and start over instantly.(3.3)
- Reversibility: Users can undo accidental cart removals.(3.1)
- Wishlist Deletion: No "Undo" option for removing items from the wishlist. Items removed from wishlist are not immediately removed, however if a user isnt paying full attention they may not notice that the heart colour has changed and are most likely to leave the page or refresh it, removing the item from the wishlist page.(3.2)
- Recommendation: Implement a "Deleted" toast notification with an "Undo" link that stays active for 5 seconds after an item is removed from the wishlist.



3.1



3.3

Wishlist

Women (9) | Men (1)

Wishlist Alerts

Receive updates on your favourite pieces. Select your size to be notified when items are back in stock, discounted, or almost sold out. Manage your settings here.

Stuart Weitzman
Boots

Brave Soul
Knitted dress

In Linea
Crew neck t-shirt

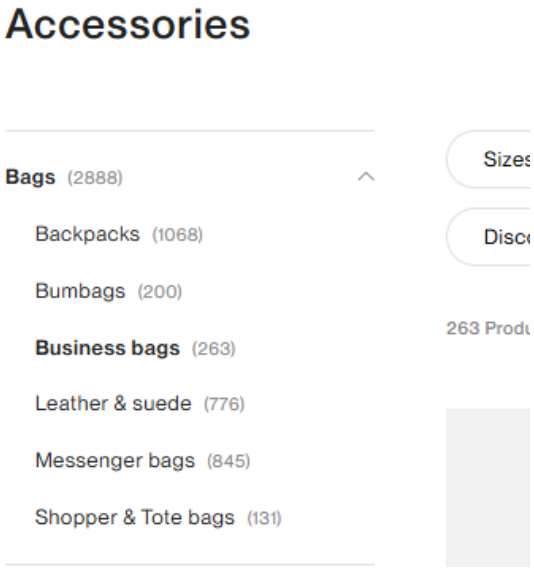
3.2

4. Consistency and standards- 1

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Navigation Logic: Dropdown menus follow a dual-standard: clicking the word (e.g., "Bags") shows all items, wh the arrow expands specific sub-types. Selected sections always have their names in bold text throughout.(4.1)
- Visual Uniformity: All items consistently display quantities in subtle grey text, ensuring the price remains the fo point while information is still accessible.(4.2).
- Usage of standard e-commerce icons(the generic user icon for the account panel, the padlock and id icon for password and contact information, letter for newsletter, question mark for FAQ)(4.3,4.4)

4.1



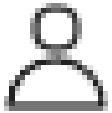
Boss Black
Leather business bag Morval DZ
~~RRP € 550,00~~ -37%*
€ 349,00

Joop!
Leather business bag
~~RRP € 429,00~~ -47%*
€ 229,00

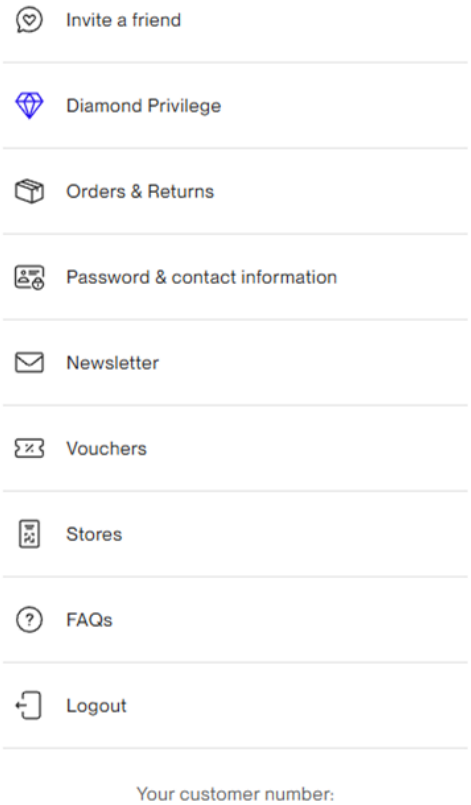
19V69 ITALIA
Business bag Ben
~~RRP € 179,99~~ -71%*
€ 52,99

4.2

4.3



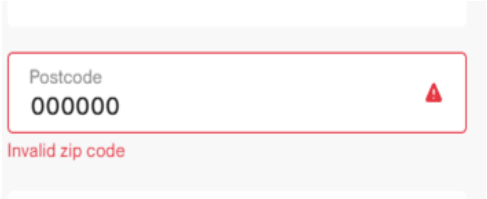
4.4

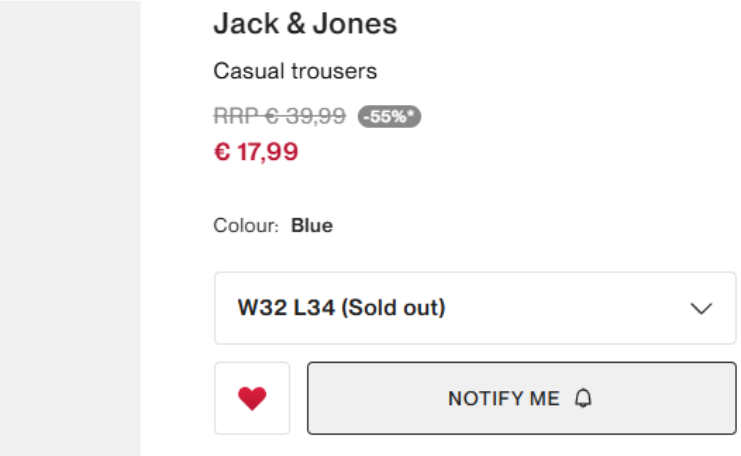

Invite a friend
Diamond Privilege
Orders & Returns
Password & contact information
Newsletter
Vouchers
Stores
FAQs
Logout
Your customer number:

5. Error prevention- 0.85

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place.

- Real-Time Forms: The system catches invalid zip codes so user cannot proceed to next step of purchase until error is rectified.
- Stock Management: Out-of-stock items replace "Add to Cart" with a "Notify Me" button, preventing the error of attempting to purchase unavailable goods.
- The same message appears for different phone number mistakes.
- Recommendation: Parameters should be put in place so that system is more specific, i.e for when too many/too little numbers are entered incase user misses a digit or mistakenly adds the same digit twice. The same should be done for other contant details to prevent user frustration.





Phone number
abcd12345

We're sorry, the phone number you entered does not meet our formatting requirements. Please enter a phone number using the following format: +37012345678

Phone number
+37012345678

We're sorry, the phone number you entered does not meet our formatting requirements. Please enter a phone number using the following format: +37012345678

We're sorry, the phone number you entered does not meet our formatting requirements. Please enter a phone number using the following format: +37012345678

After adding my real working number, but missing a digit

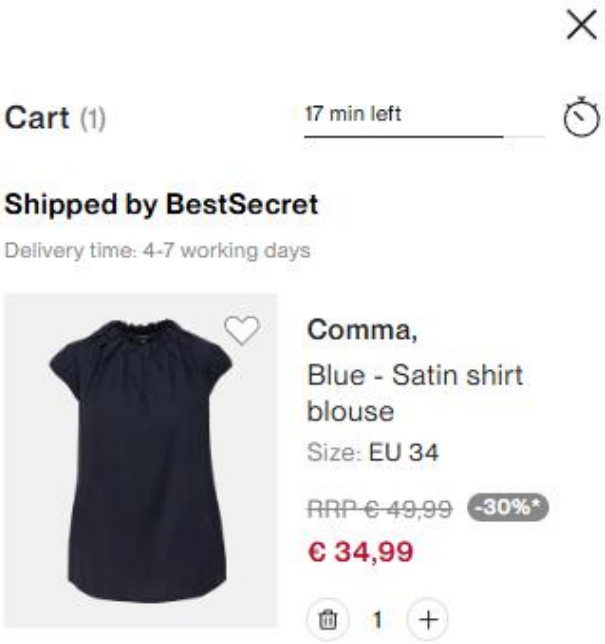
We're sorry, the phone number you entered does not meet our formatting requirements. Please enter a phone number using the following format: +37012345678

After adding my real working number plus an extra digit

6. Recognition rather than recall-0.5

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another.

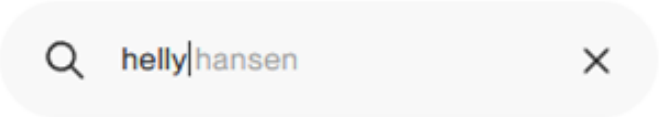
- Persistent Memory: Wishlist and cart items remain saved across different devices and sessions, even after logging out and back in.(with timing for cart)
- Information Retrieval: No "Recently Viewed" section and no personalized recommendations. Users must manually search for items they looked at minutes prior.
- Recommendation: Add a "Recently Viewed" strip at the bottom of product pages to minimize memory load, as seen on similar e-commerce platforms like ASOS



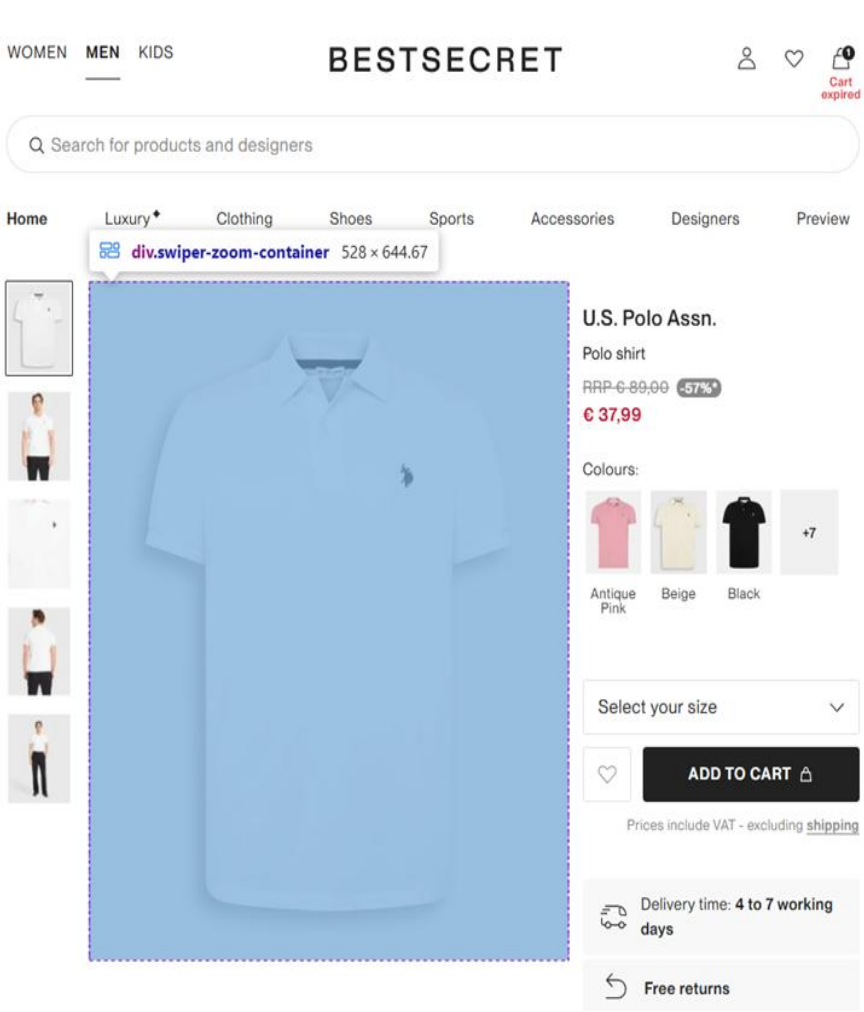
7. Flexibility and efficiency of use- 0.4

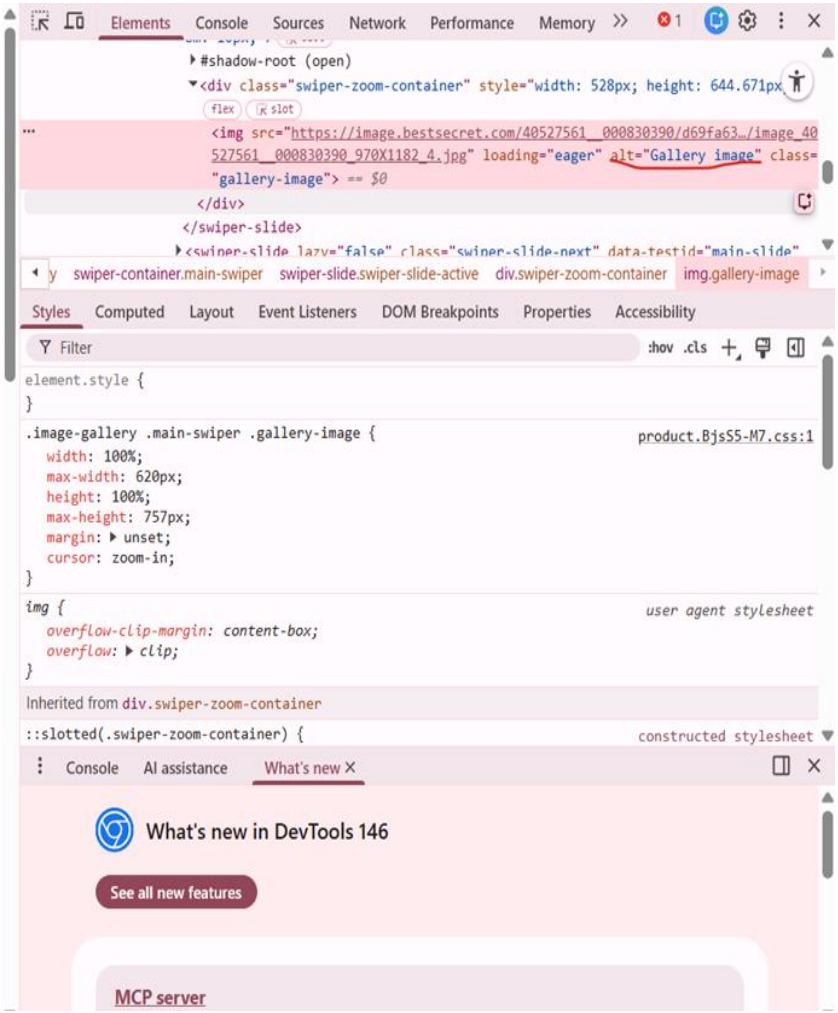
Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users.

- Power User Speed: Tab-key support for autocomplete and Enter-key to initiate search.



- Keyboard Limitation: Tabbing through the page only allows vertical scrolling; users cannot navigate sideways or select specific interactive elements via keyboard alone.
- Accessibility Barrier: "Alt Text" uses technical code (e.g gallery-image)instead of describing the item, failing
visually impaired users.(7.2)
- Recommendations: Make the website more keyboard accessible by ensuring all interactive elements (links, buttons, forms) are reachable using the Tab key, operable with Enter/Space, and provide a highly visible focus indicator & using native semantic HTML (<a>, <button>) to maintain a logical tab order and implement a "skip to content" link. This benefits expert users and keyboard limited users.
- Descriptive Alt Text: Replace technical placeholders with dynamic product titles (e.g., "Polo Ralph Lauren White
- Shirt - Front View").


WOMEN MEN KIDS
BESTSECRET
Cart expired
Search for products and designers
Home
Luxury
Clothing
Shoes
Sports
Accessories
Designers
Preview
div.swiper-zoom-container 528 × 644.67
U.S. Polo Assn.
Polo shirt
RRP € 89,00 -57%
€ 37,99
Colours:
Antique Pink
Beige
Black
+7
Select your size
ADD TO CART
Prices include VAT - excluding shipping
Delivery time: 4 to 7 working days
Free returns

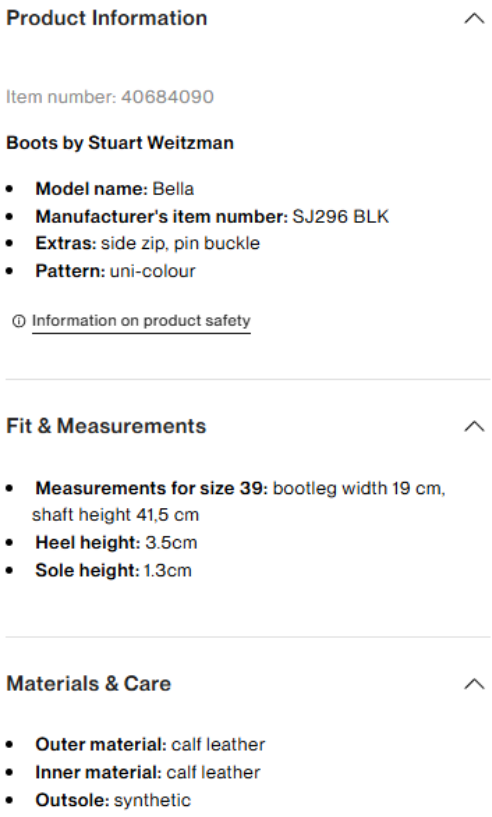

Elements Console Sources Network Performance Memory
#shadow-root (open)
<div class="swiper-zoom-container" style="width: 528px; height: 644.671px
flex slot
<img src="https://image.bestsecret.com/40527561__000830390/d69fa63…/image_40527561__000830390_970X1182_4.jpg" loading="eager" alt="Gallery image" class="gallery-image"> == $0

</swiper-slide>
swiper-container.main-swiper swiper-slide.swiper-slide-active div.swiper-zoom-container img.gallery-image
Styles Computed Layout Event Listeners DOM Breakpoints Properties Accessibility
Filter
:hov .cls
element.style {
}
.image-gallery .main-swiper .gallery-image {
product.BjsS5-M7.css:1
width: 100%;
max-width: 620px;
height: 100%;
max-height: 757px;
margin: unset;
cursor: zoom-in;
}
img {
user agent stylesheet
overflow-clip-margin: content-box;
overflow: clip;
}
Inherited from div.swiper-zoom-container
::slotted(.swiper-zoom-container) {
constructed stylesheet
Console AI assistance What's new
What's new in DevTools 146
See all new features
MCP server

8. Aesthetic and minimalist design-0.8

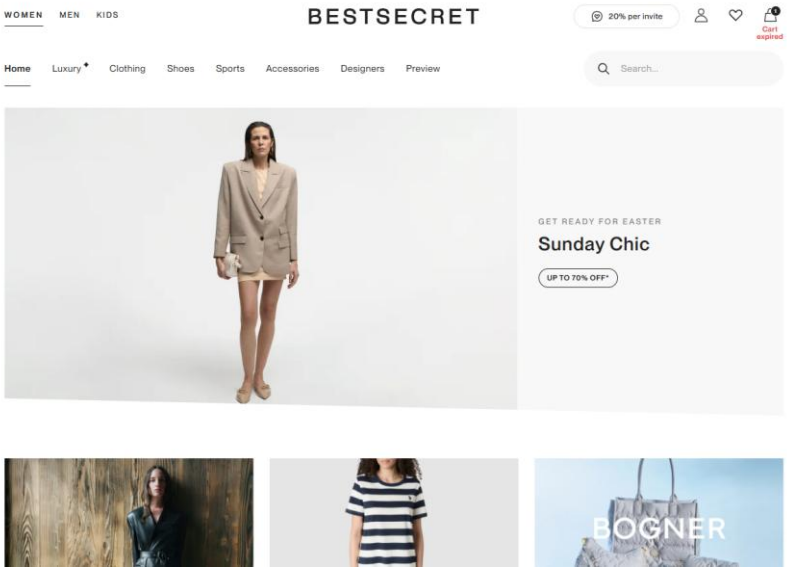
Interfaces should not contain information which is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information competes with the relevant units of information.

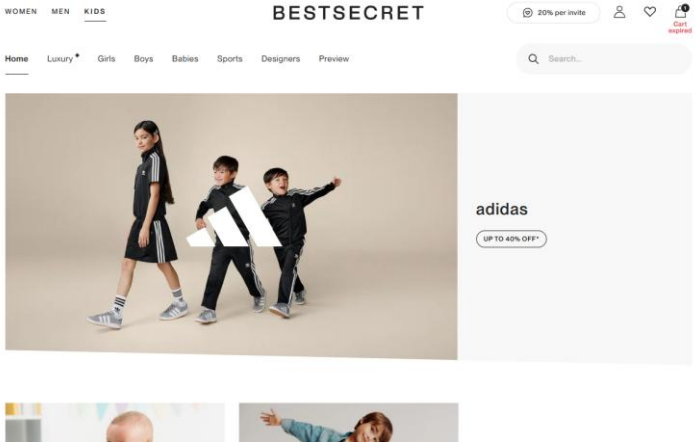
Visual Polish: Strong color contrast (Black, White, Gray) supports readability and luxury branding.
Clean Pages: Campaign pages are clean, no extra unnecessary text used. (8.1, 8.2, 8.3)
Information Overload: Item details such as product information, fits & measurements and materials & care provide excess wording that crowds the screen.
Recommendation: Product information, fits & measurements and materials & care can have their information hidden and revealed via dropdown menu to avoid overcrowding the screen.

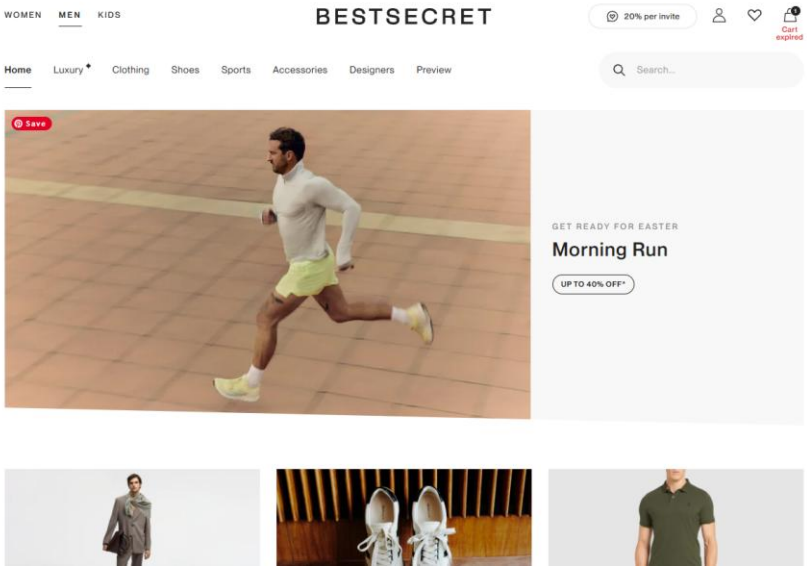


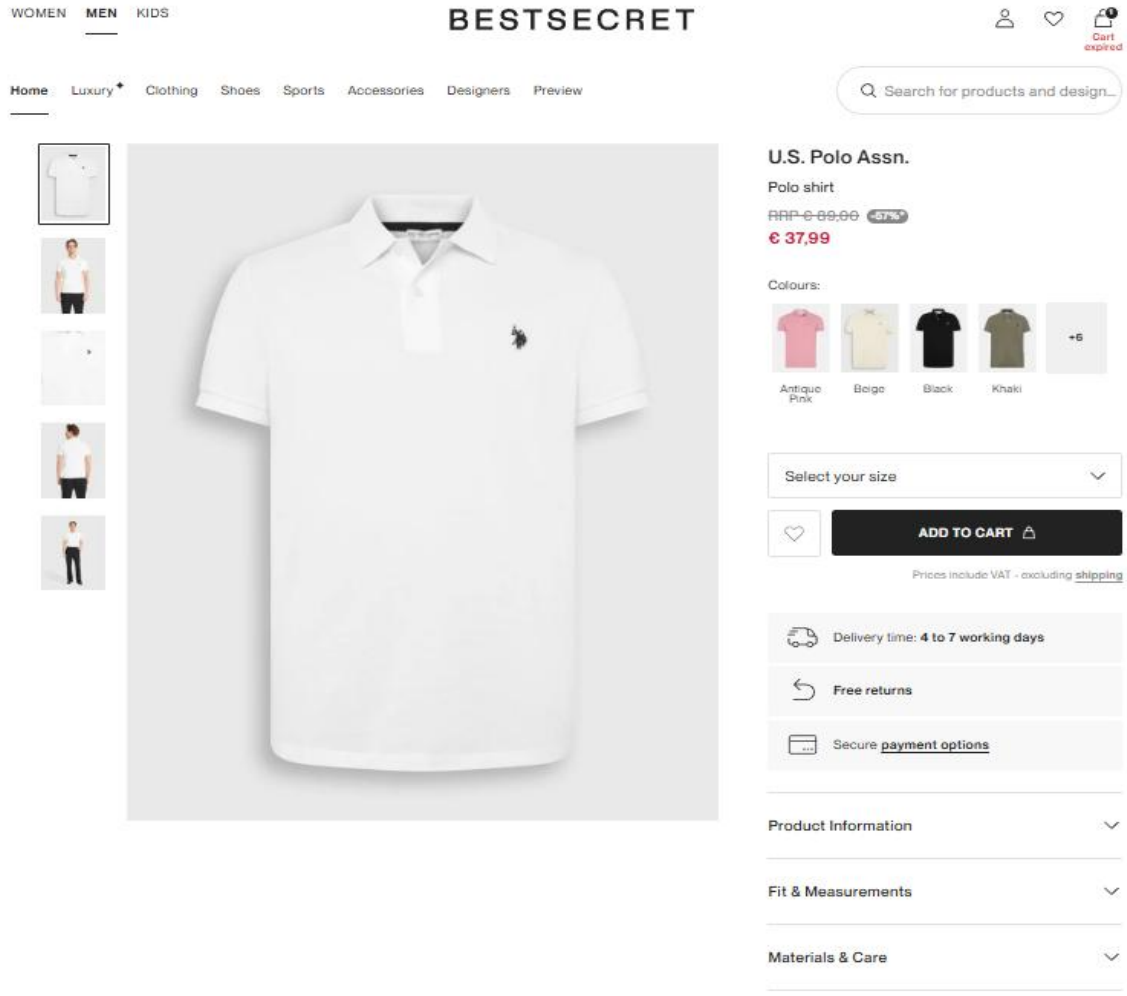
8.1 ,8.2& 8.3

No cluttered text, well spaced images and simple descriptive text.









Less text crowding the screen

9. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors-0.65

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

Checkout Guidance: Empty required fields are highlighted with immediate red text to prevent submission failure.
Effective 404 Handling: Plain-language error messages inform the user of the issue, followed by an automatic 10-second redirect to the homepage.(9.1)
Graceful Redirection: Instead of showing confusing 401/403 error codes, unauthorized or invalid links automatically redirect users to the Login or Home page.

Silent Redirections: Redirecting from invalid product links provides no feedback, leaving users confused as to why they were moved from their original destination.
Recommendations:
Link Feedback: Display a brief "Invalid Product Link" message (similar to the 404 style) before redirecting to ensure users understand the system's response

WOMEN MEN KIDS

BESTSECRET

20% per invite

Home Luxury Clothing Shoes Sports Accessories Designers Preview

Search...

THE PAGE CANNOT BE FOUND

In 10 seconds you will be forwarded to Home.

9.1

10. Help and documentation-0.6

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

Comprehensive Self-Service: A detailed FAQ section divided into six specific niches allows users to resolve queries immediately without waiting for live support.

Intuitive Labeling: Consistent use of symbols and clear category labels across the platform reduces user confusion during the search for information.

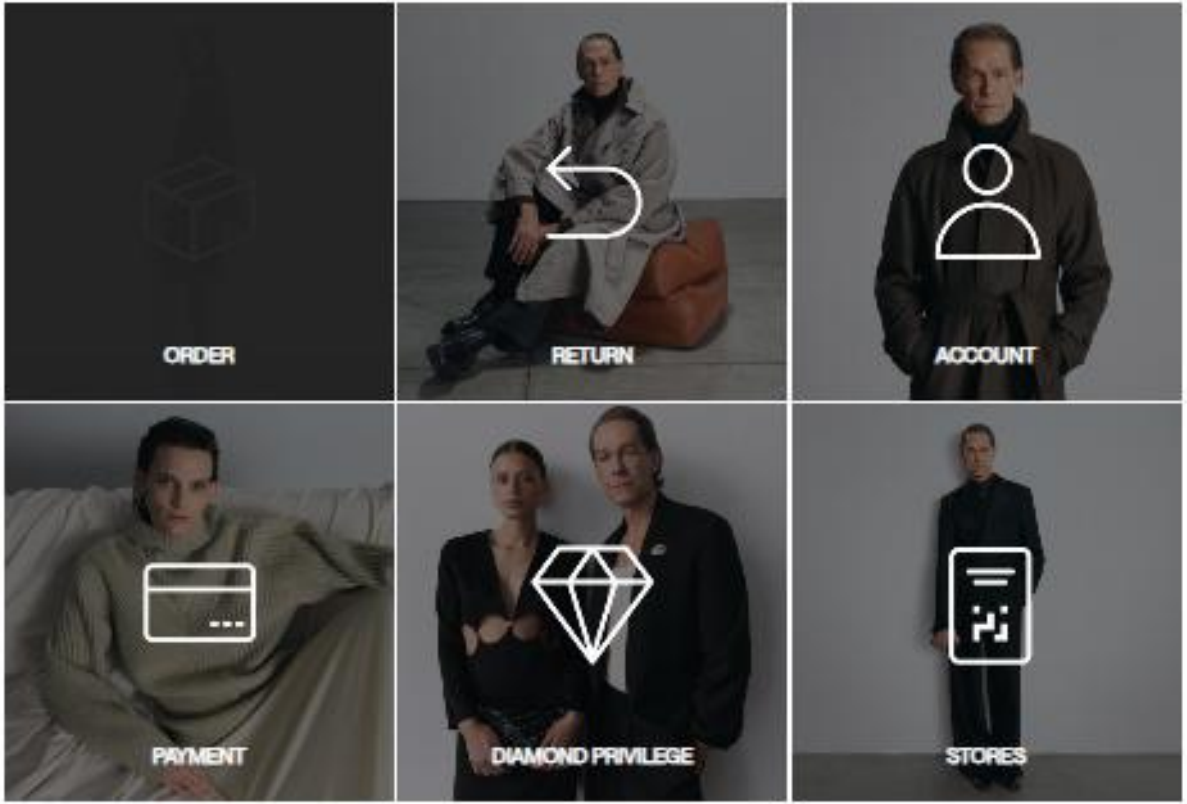
Low Discoverability: Customer service links are buried in the footer in small text, making them difficult to locate quickly.(10.2)

Non-Standard Architecture: FAQ and Help resources are isolated from the main account navigation where users typically expect to find them.

Recommendations: Optimize Placement: Move "Help" and "FAQ" links to the primary Account Panel or Header for instant access during the shopping journey.

Unified Support Hub: Group the FAQ under a prominent "Customer Service" section to align with standard user mental models.

HOW CAN WE HELP YOU?



POPULAR ARTICLES

- How do I return an item?
- Which payment methods can I use?
- How long does it take for my parcel to be delivered?
- Which countries do you ship to and how much does it cost?
- When will I be refunded?

Language

English

DIAMOND PRIVILEGE

Order

Return

Account

Payment

Diamond Privilege

Stores

ARTICLES

How can I collect points and move up to the next level?

What is a Diamond Priority Product?

Update on our commission system

What has changed in the new loyalty program?

How do I join Diamond Privilege?

How long are my points and membership level valid, and why have some points been deducted from my balance?

What is the Diamond Privilege and how does it work?

POPULAR ARTICLES

How long are my points and membership level valid, and why have some points been deducted from my balance?

How can I collect points and move up to the next level?

Update on our commission system

What is a Diamond Priority Product?

What is the Diamond Privilege and how does it work?

Language

English

10.2

Back to top

Up to 80% off top brands

Over 3,000 designer labels

Fast shipping & free 30-day returns

Diamond Privilege benefits

Customer service

Help Shipping Return Vouchers Newsletter

About BESTSECRET

Careers Corporate Website Privacy Policy Terms and Conditions Imprint

You can also find us on

Payment methods

Delivery Partners

* Compared to the RRP (manufacturer's recommended retail price). We use the RRP as a point of comparison for our current selling price.

OVERALL SCORE= 7.2/10

Strengths

- Visual consistency — luxury black/white/grey palette is uniform
- across every page (1.0/1.0)
- Real-world language & icons — hover-to-model imagery, shopping bag cart, and familiar category names lower friction (0.9/1.0)
- Error prevention — real-time zip code validation and "Notify Me" button on sold-out items stop errors before they occur (0.85/1.0)
- Minimalist design — campaign pages are clean and uncluttered, reinforcing premium brand identity (0.8/1.0)
- System feedback — cart side panel, countdown timer, throbbers, and heart icon state changes keep users informed (0.8/1.0)

OVERALL SCORE= 7.2/10

Weaknesses & severity

- Critical Accessibility failures — broken keyboard navigation and technical alt text exclude users with disabilities (0.4/1.0)
  → Implement full tab-order navigation, Enter/Space operability, visible focus indicators, and descriptive alt text per WCAG standards
- Major No "Recently Viewed" or recommendations — users must manually retrace browsing (0.5/1.0)
  → Add a "Recently Viewed" strip at the bottom of product pages, as used by ASOS and Zalando
- Moderate Help buried in footer — FAQ is disconnected from account panel (0.6/1.0)
  → Move "Help" and "FAQ" links to the account panel header for immediate access during shopping
- Moderate Silent invalid-link redirects — no explanation given when users are moved (0.65/1.0)
  → Show a brief "Invalid Product Link" message before redirecting, consistent with the existing 404 page style
- Moderate No wishlist undo — accidental removals cannot be reversed (0.7/1.0)
  → Implement a 5-second "Deleted — Undo" toast notification, mirroring the existing cart undo feature

FINAL EVALUATION

Target audience suitability- above average

- Fashion-conscious online shoppers are well served as clean layout and cart mechanics match expectations
- Cross-device wishlist and cart persistence supports multi-session browsing behaviour
- Users with disabilities face genuine barriers due to accessibility failures
- Newcomers lack the "Recently Viewed" and recommendation guidance they rely on elsewhere

Subjective verdict

BestSecret is a visually polished, brand-coherent platform with strong core shopping mechanics. The 0.7-point gap between its mobile app (4.9/5) and Trustpilot website rating (4.2/5) reflects real, correctable shortcomings. Its strengths lie in visual design and error prevention; its weaknesses in accessibility and personalisation. Addressing the critical accessibility failures; keyboard navigation and alt text, is the single highest-priority fix and would meaningfully close the quality gap between platforms.